

FIFA World Cup 2026 — Model Prediction

Generated 2026-06-16 | Engine: github.com/govindgoel2001/sportsbetting (Dixon-Coles + Elo + 10-agent panel + flank/player lanes + tactical engine + formations/chemistry + game-state event-sim Monte Carlo + probability calibration)
Ratings calibrated on 913 real internationals (2023–26, via Hicruben/world-cup-2026-prediction-model).

Read this first. The tournament has not been played — no model can tell you the actual results. These are probabilistic forecasts: even the favourite wins the title only ~22% of the time. Scorelines are the single most-likely score consistent with the predicted result; the confidence figure is the model's probability of that result. The player/lineup layer uses assumed starting XIs (analyst judgment, early-2026 knowledge), not confirmed teamsheets.

The model stack

Layer	Weight	Status	What it does
Dixon-Coles MLE	45% of base	LIVE	attack/defence fitted on 913 real results
Hicruben Elo	55% of base	LIVE	prior-anchored strength (70% form / 30% prior)
10-agent panel	multiplier	6 LIVE	form, momentum, H2H, tactician, tempo, host
└ travel/climate/news/hydratation	multiplier	prior/hook/opt	agents 7-10: priors, live news, WC2026 cooling breaks
Player / flank lanes	30% blend	ON (assumed)	positional duels by channel (e.g. winger vs full-back)
Tactical engine	additive xG	ON	style-vs-style mechanisms (high line, low block, press)
Formations + chemistry	additive xG	ON	midfield numbers, wing-backs, low block; squad cohesion
Game-state event-sim	per match	ON	19-phase sim (18 + stoppage): park-the-bus, chasing, late goals
Monte Carlo	20,000 sims	LIVE	full tournament event-sim resampled for title odds
Probability calibration	shrink 0.35	NEW	blends 1X2 toward DC+Elo core; trims favourite over-confidence

Scoreline engine $p = -0.107$ (Dixon-Coles low-score correction). Host edge applies only to USA / Mexico / Canada; every other match is neutral. Agent 9 (live squad news) is available but left off here for a reproducible document.

Title odds — 20,000 game-state event-sim simulations

Each simulation plays all 72 group games as an 18-phase game-state event sim (so leads get protected, trailing sides chase, comebacks happen), resolves standings and the eight best third-placed teams, then a seeded knockout. Win% is how often each team lifts the trophy.

#	Team	Win%	Final%	Semi%	Reach R32%	Elo
1	Spain	23.5	38.1	57.7	99	2075
2	Argentina	21.6	35.9	54.2	98	2064
3	France	12.5	23.1	42.6	95	2033
4	England	10.0	19.1	36.6	99	1990
5	Brazil	7.3	14.8	30.9	98	1999
6	Germany	4.3	10.2	20.3	97	1937
7	Morocco	3.7	8.6	18.4	96	1877
8	Portugal	3.4	8.3	19.3	94	1942
9	Netherlands	2.7	6.9	15.5	92	1939
10	Japan	2.5	6.2	14.8	94	1852
11	Colombia	1.5	4.3	10.7	91	1888
12	Belgium	0.8	3.0	7.5	95	1889
13	Senegal	0.8	2.5	6.6	84	1833
14	Ecuador	0.8	2.4	6.7	88	1796
15	Norway	0.7	2.2	6.2	85	1811
16	Uruguay	0.6	2.0	6.3	90	1834

Spain vs Argentina — the favourite question

Spain carry the highest rating (Elo 2075) and, once the assumed lineups are modelled, the best midfield in the field (Rodri–Pedri–Yamal). That midfield-control edge nudges them to narrow title favourite over Argentina. Argentina's strength is the draw: the softest group and an easier route. The gap is inside the noise — treat them as co-favourites, with the field ~55%.

Group stage — predicted scorelines & confidence

Group A

Match	Score	Result	Confidence
Korea Republic v Mexico (host)	0–1	Mexico	46% LEAN
Korea Republic v Czechia	1–0	Korea Republic	57% CLEAR
Korea Republic v South Africa	2–0	Korea Republic	66% STRONG
Mexico v Czechia (host)	2–0	Mexico	72% STRONG
Mexico v South Africa (host)	2–0	Mexico	80% STRONG
Czechia v South Africa	1–0	Czechia	49% LEAN

Qualify: ☐ Mexico 9 ☐ Korea Republic 6 ☐ Czechia 3 ☐ South Africa 0 (top 2 advance; 3rd into best-thirds race)

Group B

Match	Score	Result	Confidence
Switzerland v Bosnia	2–0	Switzerland	75% STRONG
Switzerland v Canada (host)	0–1	Canada	36% TOSS-UP
Switzerland v Qatar	2–0	Switzerland	85% STRONG
Bosnia v Canada (host)	0–2	Canada	71% STRONG
Bosnia v Qatar	2–1	Bosnia	48% LEAN
Canada v Qatar (host)	3–0	Canada	81% STRONG

Qualify: ☐ Canada 9 ☐ Switzerland 6 ☐ Bosnia 3 ☐ Qatar 0 (top 2 advance; 3rd into best-thirds race)

Group C

Match	Score	Result	Confidence
Brazil v Morocco	1–0	Brazil	36% TOSS-UP
Brazil v Scotland	2–0	Brazil	67% STRONG
Brazil v Haiti	3–0	Brazil	88% STRONG
Morocco v Scotland	1–0	Morocco	62% CLEAR
Morocco v Haiti	2–0	Morocco	85% STRONG
Scotland v Haiti	2–0	Scotland	69% STRONG

Qualify: ☐ Brazil 9 ☐ Morocco 6 ☐ Scotland 3 ☐ Haiti 0 (top 2 advance; 3rd into best-thirds race)

Group D

Match	Score	Result	Confidence
Turkey v USA (host)	2–1	Turkey	42% LEAN
Turkey v Paraguay	1–0	Turkey	48% LEAN
Turkey v Australia	1–0	Turkey	45% LEAN
USA v Paraguay (host)	2–1	USA	44% LEAN
USA v Australia (host)	2–1	USA	41% LEAN
Paraguay v Australia	0–1	Australia	36% TOSS-UP

Qualify: ☐ Turkey 9 ☐ USA 6 ☐ Australia 3 ☐ Paraguay 0 (top 2 advance; 3rd into best-thirds race)

Group E

Match	Score	Result	Confidence
Germany v Ivory Coast	2–1	Germany	57% CLEAR
Germany v Ecuador	1–0	Germany	44% LEAN

Match	Score	Result	Confidence
Germany v Curacao	4–0	Germany	89% STRONG
Ivory Coast v Ecuador	0–1	Ecuador	41% LEAN
Ivory Coast v Curacao	2–0	Ivory Coast	68% STRONG
Ecuador v Curacao	2–0	Ecuador	72% STRONG

Qualify: ☐ Germany 9 ☐ Ecuador 6 ☐ Ivory Coast 3 ☐ Curacao 0 (top 2 advance; 3rd into best-thirds race)

Group F

Match	Score	Result	Confidence
Netherlands v Japan	0–1	Japan	38% TOSS-UP
Netherlands v Sweden	2–1	Netherlands	62% CLEAR
Netherlands v Tunisia	2–0	Netherlands	70% STRONG
Japan v Sweden	2–1	Japan	63% CLEAR
Japan v Tunisia	2–0	Japan	73% STRONG
Sweden v Tunisia	2–1	Sweden	51% CLEAR

Qualify: ☐ Japan 9 ☐ Netherlands 6 ☐ Sweden 3 ☐ Tunisia 0 (top 2 advance; 3rd into best-thirds race)

Group G

Match	Score	Result	Confidence
Belgium v Egypt	1–0	Belgium	50% CLEAR
Belgium v Iran	2–1	Belgium	54% CLEAR
Belgium v New Zealand	2–0	Belgium	74% STRONG
Egypt v Iran	1–0	Egypt	37% TOSS-UP
Egypt v New Zealand	2–0	Egypt	56% CLEAR
Iran v New Zealand	1–0	Iran	58% CLEAR

Qualify: ☐ Belgium 9 ☐ Egypt 6 ☐ Iran 3 ☐ New Zealand 0 (top 2 advance; 3rd into best-thirds race)

Group H

Match	Score	Result	Confidence
Spain v Uruguay	2–0	Spain	58% CLEAR
Spain v Saudi Arabia	2–0	Spain	83% STRONG
Spain v Cape Verde	3–0	Spain	88% STRONG
Uruguay v Saudi Arabia	1–0	Uruguay	60% CLEAR
Uruguay v Cape Verde	2–0	Uruguay	64% CLEAR
Saudi Arabia v Cape Verde	1–0	Saudi Arabia	39% TOSS-UP

Qualify: ☐ Spain 9 ☐ Uruguay 6 ☐ Saudi Arabia 3 ☐ Cape Verde 0 (top 2 advance; 3rd into best-thirds race)

Group I

Match	Score	Result	Confidence
France v Senegal	1–0	France	49% LEAN
France v Norway	2–1	France	51% CLEAR
France v Iraq	2–0	France	79% STRONG
Senegal v Norway	2–1	Senegal	38% TOSS-UP
Senegal v Iraq	2–0	Senegal	69% STRONG
Norway v Iraq	2–0	Norway	71% STRONG

Qualify: ☐ France 9 ☐ Senegal 6 ☐ Norway 3 ☐ Iraq 0 (top 2 advance; 3rd into best-thirds race)

Group J

Match	Score	Result	Confidence
Argentina v Austria	1–0	Argentina	63% CLEAR
Argentina v Algeria	2–0	Argentina	66% STRONG
Argentina v Jordan	2–0	Argentina	85% STRONG
Austria v Algeria	2–1	Austria	39% TOSS-UP
Austria v Jordan	2–0	Austria	67% STRONG
Algeria v Jordan	2–0	Algeria	64% CLEAR

Qualify: ☐ Argentina 9 ☐ Austria 6 ☐ Algeria 3 ☐ Jordan 0 (top 2 advance; 3rd into best-thirds race)

Group K

Match	Score	Result	Confidence
Portugal v Colombia	2–1	Portugal	40% LEAN
Portugal v Uzbekistan	2–0	Portugal	66% STRONG
Portugal v DR Congo	2–0	Portugal	66% STRONG
Colombia v Uzbekistan	2–0	Colombia	64% CLEAR
Colombia v DR Congo	2–0	Colombia	63% CLEAR
Uzbekistan v DR Congo	0–1	DR Congo	36% TOSS-UP

Qualify: ☐ Portugal 9 ☐ Colombia 6 ☐ DR Congo 3 ☐ Uzbekistan 0 (top 2 advance; 3rd into best-thirds race)

Group L

Match	Score	Result	Confidence
England v Croatia	1–0	England	55% CLEAR
England v Ghana	2–0	England	74% STRONG
England v Panama	3–0	England	86% STRONG
Croatia v Ghana	1–0	Croatia	58% CLEAR
Croatia v Panama	2–0	Croatia	75% STRONG
Ghana v Panama	2–1	Ghana	48% LEAN

Qualify: ☐ England 9 ☐ Croatia 6 ☐ Ghana 3 ☐ Panama 0 (top 2 advance; 3rd into best-thirds race)

Knockout — most-likely (chalk) path

Pairings are the single most-likely bracket; the Monte Carlo above is the probabilistic verdict. Penalties shown only where a draw is the predicted outcome.

Round of 16

Match	Score	Result	Confidence
France v Germany	2–1	France	41% LEAN
Netherlands v Mexico	1–0	Netherlands	43% LEAN
Brazil v Senegal	1–0	Brazil	45% LEAN
England v Sweden	2–0	England	70% STRONG
Spain v Croatia	1–0	Spain	62% CLEAR
Belgium v Turkey	2–1	Belgium	38% TOSS-UP
Argentina v USA	2–0	Argentina	70% STRONG
Portugal v Switzerland	1–0	Portugal	47% LEAN

Quarter-final

Match	Score	Result	Confidence
France v Netherlands	1–0	France	45% LEAN
Spain v Belgium	1–0	Spain	62% CLEAR
Brazil v England	0–1	England	40% LEAN
Argentina v Portugal	1–0	Argentina	50% CLEAR

Semi-final

Match	Score	Result	Confidence
France v Spain	1–2	Spain	43% LEAN
Argentina v Brazil	1–0	Argentina	45% LEAN

3rd place

Match	Score	Result	Confidence
Brazil v Spain	1–2	Spain	47% LEAN

FINAL

Match	Score	Result	Confidence
Argentina v France	1–0	Argentina	41% LEAN

Key positional reads (assumed XIs)

France v Spain (Semi-final): Spain control midfield (+6 unit); MID 83.6666666666667 v 89.6666666666667, ATT 87.6666666666667 v 86.0, DEF 84.25 v 82.5; style counter v possession. France most dangerous left (+0.30 xG), Spain right (+0.12).

France Mbappe runs in behind Spain FB who pushes high (left channel)

France Mbappe beats Spain FB 1v1

France Thuram wins aerial duels vs Spain's CB pair

Argentina v Brazil (Semi-final): Argentina control midfield (+4 unit); MID 85.6666666666667 v 82.0, ATT 82.3333333333333 v 86.6666666666667, DEF 81.25 v 80.75; style transition v wing. Argentina most dangerous left (+0.08 xG), Brazil left (+0.16).

Brazil Vinicius beats Argentina FB 1v1

Brazil Raphinha runs in behind Argentina FB who pushes high (right channel)

+0.01 Brazil attack the channels/byline against a narrow block

Argentina v France (FINAL): midfield evenly matched; MID 85.6666666666667 v 83.6666666666667, ATT 82.3333333333333 v 87.6666666666667, DEF 81.25 v 84.25; style transition v counter. Argentina most dangerous right (+0.03 xG), France left (+0.22).

Argentina right wing runs in behind France T.Hernandez who pushes high (right channel)

France Mbappe beats Argentina FB 1v1

France Dembele beats Argentina FB 1v1

France v Germany (Round of 16): Germany control midfield (+3 unit); MID 83.6666666666667 v 87.0, ATT 87.6666666666667 v 83.3333333333333, DEF 84.25 v 79.0; style counter v press. France most dangerous left (+0.34 xG), Germany left (+0.13).

France Mbappe runs in behind Germany FB who pushes high (left channel)

France Mbappe beats Germany FB 1v1

France Dembele beats Germany FB 1v1

Netherlands v Mexico (Round of 16): Netherlands control midfield (+5 unit); MID 80.3333333333333 v 75.6666666666667, ATT 80.6666666666667 v 75.3333333333333, DEF 83.5 v 74.0; style balanced v possession. Netherlands most dangerous right (+0.21 xG), Mexico the middle (-0.12).

Netherlands right wing beats Mexico FB 1v1

Netherlands ST wins aerial duels vs Mexico's CB pair

Live track record & calibration — as of 16 June 2026

Ten group games have been played. The model called the result in 7 of them (5 on the strict single-most-likely outcome; the other two were draws it leaned even on). But a hit-count on 10 games means little — the honest test is a probabilistic score against baselines. Brier and log-loss below are lower-is-better; favWinPred is the average probability the model gave the eventual favourite to win, which should track the actual rate.

Model	Brier	log-loss	Outcome	favWinPred
Naive 'pick favourite'	1.000	13.82	5 / 10	100%
DC+Elo core (baseline)	0.582	0.95	5 / 10	56%
Full stack (pre-calibration)	0.607	0.98	5 / 10	61%
Full + calibration (this build)	0.597	0.97	5 / 10	58%
Actual favourite win-rate	—	—	—	50%

What the numbers actually say

- On $n=10$, the differences are within noise. A bootstrap of $\text{Brier}(\text{full}) - \text{Brier}(\text{core})$ gives $+0.025$ with a 95% CI of $[-0.04, +0.10]$ — it straddles zero. We cannot yet claim the nuance layers help or hurt; we can only say the full stack was mildly over-confident (61% vs a 50% actual, tiny-sample).
- The calibration fix is principled, not fitted. We shrink the 1X2 toward the better-behaved DC+Elo core by a fixed 0.35. Leave-one-out showed the loss-minimising shrink is unstable (0.73–1.0), so tuning it to these 10 games would be overfitting — 0.35 trims over-confidence while keeping the nuance (injuries, lanes, tactics) the model exists for.
- Three repeatable biases drove the misses: over-rating heavy favourites in openers (Switzerland 85% $\rightarrow$ 1–1 draw), under-shooting blowouts (Germany predicted $\sim$ 3–0, actual 7–1), and never ranking a draw as the single most-likely 1X2 (1–1 is often the modal scoreline even so).
- The real unlock is data, not more layers. Ten games cannot validate a model this complex. The next step that would make it genuinely strong is a multi-thousand-match historical backtest (past World Cups, qualifiers, club leagues) to calibrate every layer and prove the nuance adds signal.

What is real vs assumed

Component	Basis	Trust
Ratings, form, H2H, momentum	913 real results	Data — high
Home advantage	hosts only (USA/MEX/CAN)	Data — high
Tactician / tempo / style agents	results-derived proxies	Proxy — medium
Player / flank-lane layer	assumed XIs, analyst ratings	Judgment — indicative
Formations & squad chemistry	likely shapes, subjective cohesion	Judgment — indicative
Travel & rest agent	no fixture calendar	Prior — low
Climate & altitude agent	no venue map	Neutral hook
Hydration / cooling-break agent	WC2026 heat prior, no temp map	Prior — low
Injury / news agent	Google News RSS	Live (off here)

Honest caveats

- International results are confederation-siloed, so cross-confederation calibration is the weak link (Asian/African sides can be mis-scaled vs Europe/South America).
- Lineups assume first-choice XIs in good health; one injury or a manager's surprise reshapes a tie. Confirmed teamsheets only land ~1 hour before kickoff.
- Group standings here assume the modal scoreline in every match; real groups swing on a single upset — the Monte Carlo title odds are the probabilistic, self-consistent view.
- Confidence percentages are the model's own. Live (16 Jun 2026, 10 games) it called 7 results and scores Brier 0.60 — 0.58 after calibration — vs 0.58 for its plain DC+Elo core; on n=10 those gaps are inside bootstrap noise. Trust the ordering (STRONG > CLEAR > LEAN > TOSS-UP) more than the exact number until a multi-thousand-match historical backtest is run.

For research and entertainment only. Probabilities are not certainties. Bet responsibly.